

Explain: Is XP for me?			
If you currently use			
	Windows 9x/Me or are buying a new PC	Windows 9x/Me or are buying a new PC	Windows 2000
And use your PC	Mostly at home for Internet access, gaming and day-to-day applications	At work and use office applications on a network	For professional applications like Photoshop and 3D Studio MAX
Are looking for	A more stable and user-friendly OS	Greater security, stability and Remote Desktop access	Greater stability and multiple user management
You should	Upgrade/buy Windows XP Home	Upgrade/buy Windows XP Professional	Stick with Windows 2000 (Service Pack 2)

the 64-bit platform; obviously this XP won't run on that Pentium 4. The vital difference between the 32-bit and 64-bit versions lies in the latter's ability to access and use much more system memory. XP 64-bit can handle 16 GB of RAM and 8 TB of virtual memory space. Since memory access is much quicker than, say, fetching data from a hard disk, high-end workstations with loads of memory are better suited to make use from XP 64-bit.

.NET

The IT industry sees gold in the area of Web services. Companies such as Sun, IBM and Oracle are developing their own strategies and implementations to accommodate this future technology. .Net is the fundamental framework on which Web service applications will be used. Though it's not exactly going full steam ahead, Microsoft has decided a home and place for their upcoming services standard. The Microsoft .Net Server will be the foundation on which applications using the .Net framework will be created.

And now, the price

If you have an older version of Windows, you can buy Microsoft's upgrade version of XP Home or Professional, or you can buy the full version if you do not use Windows. The upgrade version isn't available for users of Windows 95, and

XP sold over 300,000 units in its first 3 days in the US alone. Win 98 did 400,000 units three days after its launch.

costs Rs 4,200, while the new version costs Rs 7,100. The Windows XP Professional version is much more expensive at Rs 12,400 for the full version and Rs 6,100 for the upgrade. The prices for the Home version aren't that much higher if you compare it to Windows Me which retailed at Rs 6,500 for the full version.

The ride ends

XP has been released after a lot of effort. In many aspects, this OS is a much needed, if not drastic, improvement over its predecessors. It is more stable than the Windows 9x/Me line and sports a horde of new features and enhancements. Now you have to make the decision between buying and not buying. You'll be a tough nut if you have the money, read this entire article, remain content, and not buy XP!

If you're in the market to purchase a new PC, don't look beyond XP. This version is by far the easiest one to use, as we have taken pains to explain. But if you're the kind of user who fits the profile of a Windows 98/Me user, there really isn't much reason to upgrade—unless you have a serious problem with stability and keeping your current OS intact. There is a lot of room for improvement still. But we wouldn't ask you to waste your time scouting for other options. Put your money where the experience is. ■

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Expert Tips

- 1
- The Roll Back feature can eliminate stability problems that could arise due to a newly installed device driver. This lets you revert to a previous working version by right-clicking on the device and then clicking Properties. On the Driver tab of the window, just click Roll Back Driver and follow instructions.
- 2
- To create a bootable floppy disk first place a blank disk in the floppy disk drive. Then click **Start > My Computer**. Right-click the floppy disk drive icon, and then click Format on the shortcut menu. Lastly select the 'Create an MS-DOS startup disk' option and click Start.
- 3
- Create a shortcut to Computer Management on your desktop which gives access to important tools such as Disk Management and Device Manager, click **Start > Control Panel > Performance and Maintenance > Administrative Tools**. Right-click Computer Management and select Copy. Right-click on an empty portion of the desktop and select Paste Shortcut. The same method works for other icons as well.
- 4
- The fastest way to lock your workstation is by pressing [Windows] + [L]. If you want to create a shortcut on your desktop instead, just right-click with your mouse and enter `rundll32.exe user32.dll, LockWorkStation` in the location field. Give the shortcut a name you like. That's it—just double-click on it and your computer will be locked.
- 5
- You can at last get rid of tasks on the computer from the command line by using `taskkill /pid` and the task number, or just `tskill` and the process number. Find out the task numbers and process numbers by typing `tasklist`, which will also tell you a lot about what's going on in your system.
- 6
- MSConfig, the nifty utility which was absent in Windows 2000, makes its presence felt again. Click on the Start menu and in the Run option, type `msconfig`. You now have options to start or stop services.
- 7
- Windows XP comes with a more powerful and informative tool for editing the registry entries in addition to Regedit. Use `gpedit` for this option. This option is only available for those with administrator rights.